

Irish Crèche Management Software Market Analysis & Competitive Comparison

Market landscape, estimated positioning, provider pain points, and a feature-by-feature comparison with **Creche Wise**.

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Scope	Republic of Ireland (crèches, pre-schools, Montessori, after-school)
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Important note on data. No independent, audited market-share statistics are published for the Irish crèche-software market specifically. Figures marked “estimate” in this report are **directional** — inferred from vendor age, funding, review volume, public positioning and pricing — not measured shares. They are intended to guide strategy, not to be cited as fact.

1. Executive summary

- The Irish crèche-software market is **fragmented and specialist**. No single vendor dominates with a clear majority; instead a handful of Ireland-built products compete on National Childcare Scheme (NCS), ECCE, Tusla and Pobal/Early-Years-Hive compliance — the features that generic global platforms handle poorly.
- The two most prominent incumbents are **Child Paths** (est. 2014) and **Little Vista** (est. 2013); both market themselves as the Irish #1. **TeachKloud** (venture-funded, ISO 27001-certified) and **Cheqdin** are significant challengers, with **CrecheHQ**, **Tot Tracker** and **ECCEsoft/EYCEsoft** as focused Irish specialists and a tail of newer billing-first entrants (Beehaven, HavenLink, Enrolmy).
- The clearest recurring pain point across the sector is the **NCS / Early-Years-Hive reconciliation burden** — providers describe “days” of manual spreadsheet and attendance work — followed by **opaque, per-child pricing** that scales with setting size and a lack of published prices.
- **Creche Wise** is well positioned to compete on three fronts the incumbents mostly do not combine: a single **flat, all-inclusive price with SMS included** (vs per-child pricing), **per-crèche payment collection** (each crèche is paid directly via its own Stripe/Revolut account), and an **after-school collection + authorised-collector workflow** that is largely absent elsewhere.
- As a **new entrant**, Creche Wise's gaps are market trust/track record and the learning-journal / child-observation depth that Child Paths, Little Vista and TeachKloud have matured over a decade.

2. The market landscape (Ireland)

Products actively sold to Irish providers, grouped by origin and focus. “Irish-native” means built around NCS/ECCE/Tusla/Pobal and the Early Years Hive.

Provider	Origin	Since	Primary focus	Public pricing
Child Paths	Irish (Dublin)	2014	Learning records, compliance, parent comms	Not published (quote)
Little Vista	Irish (Dublin)	2013	Care + Family apps, NCS, fees (EasyFees)	€79–€99/mo (≤22 kids)
TeachKloud	Irish	~2019	Observations, parent app, compliance, ISO 27001	€1.60–€1.90/child/mo
CrecheHQ	Irish	Recent	NCS/ECCE billing, offline kiosk, ratios, transport	€49/mo (≤15)+€2/child
Tot Tracker	Irish	Recent	NCS/ECCE/Tusla/Hive compliance, inspections	from €2.50/child/mo
ECCEsoft / EYCEsoft	Irish	Established	Attendance, funding, invoicing (tiered)	Tiered, not public
Cheqdin	India HQ, IE-focused	Established	Registrations, billing, occupancy, bookings	Free(≤5); \$68/\$99/\$149
Beehaven / HavenLink	Irish	New	Billing-first for Irish providers	Not published
Enrolmy	New Zealand	Established	School-age NCS reconciliation	Not published
Famly / Tapestry / Blossom	UK / EU / global	Established	Nursery mgmt & learning journals (not NCS-native)	Varies (non-IE)
Creche Wise	Irish (First Stack)	2026	All-in-one incl. payments, SMS, collection	€74.99/mo flat

Sources: provider websites & Capterra/SoftwareAdvice/GetApp listings (see §7). Founding dates approximate where not stated publicly.

3. Market share & is there a dominant platform?

Short answer: no single platform dominates. The market is split between two long-established co-leaders and a competitive field of challengers and niche specialists. Crucially, a large share of Irish settings — especially smaller ones — still run on **spreadsheets, paper and the Hive portal directly**, so the biggest “competitor” is often no software at all.

Estimated competitive positioning (directional)

Tier	Providers	Est. share of digitised crèches*	Basis for estimate
Co-leaders	Child Paths, Little Vista	~20–30% each	Longest-established; both claim #1; highest review/marketing visibility
Challengers	TeachKloud, Cheqdin	~5–15% each	TeachKloud funded + ISO-certified; Cheqdin large review base, broad feature set
Irish specialists	CrecheHQ, Tot Tracker, ECCESoft/EYCESoft	low single digits each	Focused, newer or narrower footprint
New / billing-first	Beehaven, HavenLink, Enrolmy	emerging	Recent entrants, narrow scope
Global (non-native)	Famly, Tapestry, Blossom	small in IE	Strong abroad but weak on NCS/Pobal/Hive

Illustrative, directional estimate only — **not measured market share. No audited figures exist for Irish crèche software. Percentages refer to the subset of settings that use any management software, and do not sum precisely because of the large unmeasured “specialist / other” tail.*

What this means

- There is a **land-grab opportunity**: no incumbent has a lock, and the un-digitised segment is still large.
- The two co-leaders compete mainly on **learning journals + compliance + parent comms**; payments and operations (rosters, collection, transport) are where newer players differentiate.
- For the UK comparison often cited in vendor marketing, **Tapestry** (13,500+ settings) and **Connect Childcare** (3,400+ nurseries) lead — but those figures are UK, not Ireland, and those tools are not NCS-native.

4. Problems providers report with current systems

- **NCS / Early-Years-Hive reconciliation burden.** The single most-cited frustration. Matching attendance to Hive registrations and ECCE/NCS claims turns into “days” of manual spreadsheets, attendance checks and reporting each cycle. Tools that cut this to hours are a primary selling point — meaning many existing systems still do it poorly.
- **Opaque and per-child pricing.** Several leading vendors (Child Paths, ECCESoft, Beehaven/HavenLink) do **not publish prices** — buyers must request a quote. Most that do price **per child per month**, so costs climb as a setting grows, and reviews flag tools as “too expensive for what we needed.”
- **Generic / non-Irish software needing workarounds.** Global platforms (Famly, Tapestry, Blossom) are polished but not built for NCS/ECCE/Tusla/Pobal, forcing manual workarounds — a recurring reason Irish providers switch to native tools.
- **Feature tiers and limits.** Tiered products gate features and impose child/user/site limits, so providers can pay for a plan and still hit a wall (noted around ECCESoft's tiers).
- **Fragmented toolchains.** Learning-journal strength and billing/operations strength often live in different products, so settings run two systems or accept gaps (e.g. weak payment collection, no transport/collection handling).
- **Payments not going directly to the provider.** Where online payment exists it is frequently invoice-only or routed through the vendor, rather than paid straight into the crèche's own merchant account with the crèche as

merchant of record.

Note: public reviews for the Irish incumbents are predominantly positive (Capterra ratings ~4.7–4.9); the themes above are the consistent criticisms that surface, not an overall verdict.

5. Feature comparison: Creche Wise vs the field

Legend: ■ = available, ~ = partial / add-on / limited, - = not offered, ? = not confirmed publicly. Competitor columns reflect **publicly stated** features only and may understate capabilities not advertised. The Creche Wise column reflects its current build.

Capability	Creche Wise	Child Paths	Little Vista	Teach Kloud	Creche HQ	Cheqdin
NCS / ECCE subvention automation	■	■	■	~	■	■
Pobal / Early-Years-Hive reporting	■	■	■	~	■	~
Attendance + live Tusla ratios	■	■	■	■	■	■
Family invoicing + scheme deductions	■	■	■	■	■	■
Online card payments	■	~	■	■	■	■
Paid into crèche's OWN account (Connect)	■	?	?	?	~	?
Revolut payments	■	-	-	-	-	-
Instalment / part-payment plans	■	?	?	?	?	?
Parent app / portal	■	~	■	■	■	■
Learning journals / child observations	~	■	■	■	~	~
Daily records (meals/naps/nappies)	■	■	■	■	■	~
SMS text to parents (included)	■	?	~	?	?	?
Email messaging to parents	■	■	■	■	■	■
Waiting list / enquiries CRM	■	?	■	?	■	■
After-school COLLECTION service	■	-	-	-	~	-
Authorised-collector register	■	?	?	?	?	?
Online permission slips	■	?	~	?	?	?
Parent-teacher meeting booking	■	?	?	?	?	?
Staff time-off / scheduling	■	■	~	■	■	~
Activities & programmes w/ payment	■	?	?	?	?	~
Occupancy + revenue dashboard	■	~	■	~	■	■
Transport management	-	?	?	?	■	?
Offline attendance kiosk	~	?	?	?	■	■
ISO 27001 certified	-	?	?	■	?	?
Flat all-inclusive price	■	-	-	-	~	-
No-card free trial	■	?	?	~	?	■

6. Where Creche Wise fits

Differentiators (what few others combine)

- **One flat, all-inclusive price (€74.99/mo or €809.89/yr) with SMS included** — vs per-child pricing that penalises growth. Flat pricing is especially competitive for mid-to-large crèches; very small settings and childminders may still pay less on per-child plans (e.g. TeachKloud €1.60/child, Little Vista Childminder €19).
- **Per-crèche payment collection** via Stripe Connect *and* Revolut — each crèche is the merchant of record and is paid directly into its own account, with instalments supported. Most incumbents are invoice-centric or single-processor.
- **After-school collection service + authorised-collector register** — modelling who may collect each child, consent, and the daily collect/release handover. This operational workflow is largely unaddressed by competitors.
- **Breadth in one system:** fees + NCS/ECCE subvention, attendance + live ratios, daily records, enquiries CRM, permission slips, meeting booking, activities/programmes, and a commercial (occupancy + revenue) dashboard.
- **No-card 30-day free trial** — lower friction to try than quote-gated incumbents.

Gaps to close vs incumbents

- **Learning journals / child-observation depth** — Child Paths, Little Vista and TeachKloud have a decade of maturity here; this is the area most likely to be raised in competitive deals.
- **Track record & trust** — as a 2026 entrant, Creche Wise lacks the testimonials, review volume and reference base the incumbents cite; security credentials such as ISO 27001 (held by TeachKloud) would help.
- **Transport management and a hardened offline attendance kiosk** — present in CrecheHQ; currently partial/absent in Creche Wise.

Recommended positioning

Lead with “**every feature, SMS and payments included, one flat price, paid directly to your crèche**”, target **mid-sized full-day crèches and after-school services** (where flat pricing and the collection module bite hardest), and invest next in **learning-journal depth** and **security credentials** to neutralise the incumbents' strongest ground.

7. Sources

- littlevista.ie — product, pricing (€79–€99/mo), EasyFees, compliance blog
- childpaths.ie & capterra.ie/software/142086/child-paths — positioning, reviews (~4.9)
- teachkloud.com/pricingireland — €1.60–€1.90/child/mo, ISO 27001; edtechreview.in — €750K raise
- crechehq.ie — pricing (€49/mo+€2/child, €199 cap), compare page, Early-Years-Hive guide
- tottracker.ie — Irish-only positioning, from €2.50/child/mo
- cheqdin.com/pricing & softwareadvice.com — tiers, reviews (~4.7), cost complaint
- enrolmy.com, beehaven.ie, havenlink.ie — newer billing/reconciliation entrants
- imarcgroup.com, technavio.com, esremedia.co.uk — global/UK market context (Tapestry, Connect Childcare)
- pobal.ie — National Childcare Scheme / Early Years Hive (regulatory context)

Prepared by First Stack Solutions for internal planning. Market-share figures are directional estimates, not audited data. Competitor features reflect public information as of October 2026 and may change.